South Indian Vegetarian Meal Plan

Balanced Tamil-Style Nutrition & Active Lifestyle Plan

Target: Male (178 cm, 70 kg)
Location: Chennai, India
Goal: Maintenance & Vitality

~2,050	75 g	280 g	40 g	50 g
CALORIES / DAY	PROTEIN	CARBOHYDRATES	DIETARY FIBRE	HEALTHY FATS

7-DAY MEAL SCHEDULE

Day	Early Morning	Breakfast	Mid-Morning	Lunch	Evening Snack	Dinner
Mon	Warm lemon water + 5 almonds	**3 Idlis + Sambar:** 1 cup sambar + 2 tbsp coconut-chana dal chutney	1 cup tender coconut water + meat	**Rice & Kootu:** 1 cup brown rice, 1 cup spinach kootu, 1 cup carrot-beans poriyal, rasam, 1 cup curd	1 cup boiled chana sundal + filter coffee/tea	3 phulkas + 1 cup veg dal tadka + salad (30 min)
Tue	Warm jeera water + 2 walnuts	**2 Pesarattu:** Green gram pesarattu + 2 tbsp ginger-tamarind chutney	1 seasonal fruit (Guava / Sweet Lime)	**Millet Sambar Rice:** 1 cup foxtail millet sambar rice + 1 cup cluster beans poriyal + spiced buttermilk	1 cup boiled peanut sundal + green tea/coffee	2 adai + ½ cup light vegetable avial (25 min)
Wed	Chia seed water (1 tsp)	**Veg Oats Upma:** 1.5 cups oats upma with veggies + ½ cup fresh curd	1 cup papaya cubes	**Tamil Meals:** 1 cup rice, 1 cup tuvar dal w/ ghee, 1 cup ridge gourd kootu, beetroot poriyal, rasam, curd	1 cup roasted makhana / chana + filter coffee	3 chapatis + 1 cup low-oil chana masala + raita (30 min)
Thu	Warm coriander seed water + 5 almonds	**2 Rava Veg Dosa:** Onion-carrot rava dosa + ½ cup tomato chutney	1 banana (Sevvazhai or Karpooravalli)	**Barnyard Millet Meal:** 1 cup barnyard millet + 1 cup drumstick sambar + vendakkai poriyal + rasam + curd	1 cup sprout salad / sweet corn + tea/coffee	2 ragi dosas + ½ cup paneer bhurji + chutney (25 min)
Fri	Warm water + 5 almonds + 2 walnuts	**Veg Red Rice Poha:** 1.5 cups poha with peanuts & peas + lemon	1 cup watermelon or orange	**Rajma Rice Meal:** 1 cup brown rice + 1 cup rajma + 1 cup broad beans poriyal + spiced buttermilk	1 cup green gram sprout sundal + coffee/tea	3 phulkas + 1 cup keerai kadayal + salad (30 min)
Sat	1 glass water + 1 tsp amla juice	**Ven Pongal:** 1 cup rice-moong dal pongal (1 tsp ghee) + 1 cup veg gosthu	1 glass spiced buttermilk with curry leaves	**Variety Rice:** 1 cup lemon rice + 1 cup cowpea (karamani) sundal/kootu + roasted papad + raita	1 cup roasted green moong + tea/coffee	1.5 cups broken wheat (samba godhumai) upma (20 min)
Sun	Warm water + 5 almonds	**2 Utthappam / Dosa:** Onion-tomato utthappam + ½ cup vegetable sambar	1 cup fresh tender coconut water	**Special Meal:** 1 cup brown/jeera rice + 1 cup soy nugget curry + raw banana poriyal + garlic rasam + curd	1 cup black chana sundal + coffee/tea	3 phulkas + 1 cup mushroom & green pea curry (35 min)

Nutritional Estimate Disclaimer: Portions and values are approximate estimates derived from standard Indian Food Composition

CHENNAI GROCERY LIST

Vegetables & Keerai

- **Greens:** Sirukeerai, Araikkeerai, Murungakeerai, Spinach.
- **Native Veg:** Snake gourd, Ridge gourd, Bottle gourd, Chow-chow, Raw banana, Drumstick.
- **Staples:** Sambar onions, Tomatoes, Carrots, Beans, Vendakkai, Capsicum, Cucumber, Ginger.

Grains, Millets & Pulses

- **Grains:** Parboiled rice, Brown rice, Rolled oats, Red rice poha, Samba wheat rava, Atta.
- **Millets:** Thinai (Foxtail), Kuthiraivali (Barnyard), Ragi flour.
- **Pulses:** Tuvar dal, Yellow moong dal, Whole green gram, Urad dal, Chana, Karamani, Rajma.

Dairy, Fruits & Pantry

- **Dairy:** Low-fat milk, Curd, Paneer (150g).
- **Fruits:** Sevvazhai/Karpooravalli bananas, Papaya, Guava, Pomegranate, Sathukudi.
- **Pantry:** Gingelly oil, Cow Ghee, Mustard, Cumin, Hing, Sambar/Rasam powder, Nuts/Seeds.

Weekend Meal Prep (60–90 Mins)

1. **Batter Prep (30 min):** Soak and grind rice/millets and urad dal on Sunday. Ferment overnight for quick idli/dosa during busy weekdays.
2. **Batch Cook Legumes (20 min):** Pressure cook Kabuli chana, black chana, and karamani with salt. Store in airtight steel containers for quick evening sundals.
3. **Produce Chop (20 min):** Wash, dry, and chop sturdy vegetables (carrots, beans, chow-chow). Box them with paper towels to absorb moisture.
4. **Chutney & Spice Base (15 min):** Prepare ginger-garlic paste and roast groundnut-chana dal mix for instant weekday chutneys.

Smart Substitutions

- **Brown Rice:** Swap with unpolished ponni rice, hand-pounded rice, or millets (*Thinai / Varagu / Kuthiraivali*).
- **Paneer:** Replace with sauteed tofu or sprouted legumes for variation.
- **Curd / Buttermilk:** Use peanut-based or coconut-based curd for lactose sensitivity.
- **Oats / Poha:** Substitute with semolina (*rava*), broken wheat, or ragi vermicelli.
- **Seasonal Fruits:** Choose locally sourced papaya, guava, or local oranges (*sathukudi*).

PRACTICAL LIFESTYLE & DINING GUIDELINES

Hydration & Beverages

- **Water:** Aim for 2.5–3.5 liters daily. Keep a dedicated stainless steel bottle at your desk.
- **Coffee / Tea:** Cap South Indian filter coffee/tea to 2 cups/day. Use toned milk and max ½ tsp sugar per cup.

Dining Out & Cafeteria

- **Steamed Over Fried:** Pick 3 Idlis or 2 Phulkas with Dal instead of Medu Vada or Puri Masala.
- **Office Lunch:** Request extra poriyal/kootu; ask for less oil/vanaspati on chapatis and skip papad/sweets.

Plate Method & Activity

- **Plate Distribution:** ½ vegetables/poriyal, ¼ protein (dal/kootu/chana), ¼ complex carbs (rice/phulka).
- **Activity:** 30 mins moderate exercise 5 days/week (brisk walking/cycling/gym). Take 5-min walk breaks hourly.